2.4 Chronic Pain

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My back has hurt for more than a year." • Puts the pain at 6/10 most days **Objective** • Posture and gait have changed • Doing much less than before • Has used analgesics for a long time	**ACTUAL** **Chronic pain** related to chronic musculoskeletal condition as evidenced by pain for more than 3 months and reduced activity.	Within 1 week, pain is at a level that lets her get through daily activities. She can use two pain relief methods that do not involve drugs.	• Find out the pattern of the pain, what sets it off and how it affects her day. • Give analgesics on a regular schedule, as prescribed. • Teach heat application, relaxation and how to pace her activities. • Encourage gentle exercise along the lines the physiotherapist recommends. • Talk about the risks of taking too much analgesia.	Manages daily activities with pain at 4/10 or less: **goal met**. If not, refer her to the pain clinic.
Subjective • "I cannot fall asleep because of the pain." **Objective** • Tired, finds it hard to concentrate • Sleeps less than 4 hours a night	**ACTUAL** **Insomnia** related to persistent pain as evidenced by difficulty falling asleep and fatigue.	Says her sleep is better within 1 week.	• Ask about her sleep pattern. • Suggest going to bed at the same time each night and no caffeine in the evening. • Give analgesia before bed, as prescribed. • Teach a relaxation routine to use before sleep.	Sleeping 6 hours or more: **goal met**.
Subjective • "Nothing I do helps." **Objective** • Has been ill for a long time • Can no longer do her usual role at work and at home	**RISK** **Risk for powerlessness** as evidenced by risk factors: chronic illness and loss of control over daily life.	She takes part in decisions about her pain plan.	• Let her help set the goals. • Give her choices about when care and activities happen. • Point out progress, however small. • Refer to a support group or counselling when it seems right.	Joins in planning and sets herself realistic goals: **goal met**.